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November 20, 2025

Hiring Committee
Cornerstone Research
1900 K Street NW, Suite 900
Washington, DC 20006

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Associate position at Cornerstone Research. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households. These themes align well with Cornerstone Research's approach to applying rigorous economic analysis, empirical methods, and data-driven reasoning to complex litigation, financial, and regulatory matters.

In my job-market paper, I calibrate a life-cycle heterogeneous-agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns — finding a hump-shaped relationship for returns and characterizing the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to: (i) frame research strategies and design modeling approaches; (ii) execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro-data sets; and (iii) translate results into clear, rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am particularly excited about Cornerstone Research's model of integrating academic expertise with in-house analytic capabilities to address high-stakes, data-intensive questions. My quantitative toolkit (Python, Stata), experience with constructing and validating models, and my ability to distill complex economic analysis into clear, defensible insights position me to contribute meaningfully to litigation, antitrust, finance, and regulatory matters.

I believe I would be a strong fit at Cornerstone Research because:

1. My experience with simulation-based modeling, structural estimation, and empirical validation aligns closely with the analytical frameworks used in expert testimony and litigation support.
2. My research on heterogeneity in returns, portfolio accumulation, and wealth dynamics connects

directly to casework involving damages estimation, financial valuation, market behavior, and competition analysis.

3. I bring strong communication and collaboration skills necessary for success in a consulting environment—working across teams, supporting expert economists, and producing high-impact written and quantitative work.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to Cornerstone Research in any of its offices. My preferred locations are *Washington, DC; San Francisco; Los Angeles; and Chicago*, and I would be glad to join whichever office would benefit most from my skills.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

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